



SELN Monthly Network Meeting

Key Takeaways

January 21, 2026

Overview

- This meeting was held as an open forum followed by announcements about our 2026 work group series and other project business.

Data Minute

- Since 2016, facility-based work (FBW) services offered by intellectual and developmental disability (IDD) agencies have decreased each fiscal year.
- Over the same time period, nonwork services have increased year after year.
- For more information on these national and state trends, please visit [the StateData website](#).
- Your team may also request a Data Deep Dive, an opportunity to meet with the Data team to explore how your state's data on outcomes for people with disabilities informs policy priorities. [Submit a request here](#).

The Next Chapter in Nonwork Working Group Series: A Call to Action

- The SELN will host a series of three work group sessions to understand and act on the growth in nonwork services and to support competitive integrated employment outcomes.
- These sessions build on the 2025 work group sessions, and we anticipate high levels of engagement again this year.
- To register, please check out the [links in this flyer](#).

Open Forum

- Melissa Gituma from Oklahoma followed-up on her [Discussion question](#) regarding developing a task force to rethink paying sub-minimum wage. Has the movement away

from use of the certificate changed how services are rendered in your state? Do the individuals who were affected continue to maintain their employment? Do you have any words of advice or lessons learned?

- Joe Longcor from Michigan discussed that the Developmental Disabilities Council (DDC) championed and pushed forward efforts to reduce sub-minimum wage use from 8,200 people to about 700 people.
- Alix Dean from New Mexico mentioned that they only have one remaining subminimum wage site in the state and work hard to make sure everyone is in the right employment situation for them and has the right resources. Although there are still 49 people working at this site, no HCBS 1915(c) waiver funds can be used for services at this location. There are other Medicaid dollars paying this employer as they are a Medicaid provider. They are trying to figure out how to end subminimum wage at this last location and one hang up is that there's a personal needs allowance statutory rule in NM administrative code that they need to figure out the step to increase that personal needs allowance as those participants are also in an ICF. Adam Schand added to his colleague's statement that working with people with lived experience is invaluable in these types of processes.
- Megan Burr from Washington discussed that they ended the practice of subminimum wage certificates recently and is happy to chat anytime about lessons learned. One thing that was critical to their success of transitioning folks to competitive employment and/or community inclusion was investing in training and technical assistance for providers and clients through a dedicated staff member at the state that worked with support teams to help people transition over the course of 5 years. The Washington state legislature also required tracking where folks went and an [annual report](#) on this was created with the Department of Labor and Industries.
- Holly McCarthy from Massachusetts said their state had a similar experience to Washington and is also happy to chat with others about lessons learned.
- Pam Burton from Alaska stated although the state no longer allows sub-minimum wage, it makes me think this would be a great Data Dive opportunity for them to explore the effect of that by looking at if those individuals went to paid CIE, or if sub-minimum wage employment was replaced by day habilitation. Heather Chord added to her colleague's statement that focus groups with service recipients and their families/guardians who utilize sites with 14(c) certificates is a step worth taking.
- Stephanie Jones from Maryland mentioned that they were able to help people move into jobs in the community through thinking outside the box on meaningful activities

in the person's day. These efforts coincided with updates to their service definitions and the [Ken Capone Equal Employment Act](#).

- Rosemary Morales from Louisiana talked about how she uses the HCBS Setting Rule language and compliance efforts to disallow sheltered workshops through waiver services. When sheltered workshops closed, non-work service use went up. However, at least now there's a push for community engagement and community integration in inclusive settings. Maybe the process could have been more systematic, but at least now people are more integrated in community, and some have transitioned to work and even those in group employment do need to be paid at least minimum wage. It seems like people moving into non-work will happen no matter what.
- Christine Gudgin from Georgia said they passed the Dignity in Pay Act last year that will end 14(c) wage certificates in Georgia over the next two years. The work was spearheaded by the Georgia Council on Developmental Disabilities. The first milestone is for all people to be paid at least half of minimum wage but July 1, 2026, and full minimum wages by July 1, 2027. The majority of the 14(c) certificate holders were up for renewal in November of 2025, and they chose not to renew. By August 2026 there should be some data available.
- Kristy Howe from Minnesota worked with their task force on eliminating subminimum wages. Many of their recommendations were passed in the 2023 state legislative session, except ending subminimum wages in waiver services. She is happy to share more with others about the process.
- Comments from the SELN National Team included David Hoff acknowledging there is not great data on what happens to people after subminimum wages end, but it is very possible people are going to day services and non-work services. Transitioning services needs to be done thoughtfully as part of a systems change effort. Wesley Anderson reminded states that there is not a non-disruptive way to transition services, but not being disruptive wasn't necessarily the goal. When people go from sheltered work, they rarely go directly to supportive employment, which highlights that the sheltered work is not preparing for the transition to CIE. Jean Winsor commented on Vermont's approach and how they did a [study of the long-term impact of eliminating sheltered employment](#).
- Kristine Snyder from New York asked for examples of MOU/MOIs that address how a provider bills for services when one staff is working concurrently with individuals from different funding sources. Typically, this is the IDD agency, VR agency, and other such as mental health agencies.

- Stephanie Jones from Maryland commented that they just completed an [MOU with their VR counterpart](#). Within the MOU, how the two agencies can work together is outlined in terms of sequencing services.
- Sandy Keyser from Missouri shared that they have some guidance specifically spelled out in their service definitions. Namely that VR and DD services cannot both be paying for the same service at the same time, so they have creatively broken out distinct phases of employment services. For example, VR can support job exploration tasks while DD supports pre-vocational services. They also have a few guidance documents developed in collaboration that spell out even more when to use VR and when to use waiver funding. VR's involvement is required when requesting an employment service also offered by VR. At minimum a statement of VR's involvement or lack of must be included in the Person-Centered Support Plan.
 - [Employment Support Coordination for HCBS Technical Assistance and Guidance](#)
 - [VR Missouri VR-DD Guidance Document](#)
 - [All DD Home and Community-Based Waivers: Employment Services](#)
- Heather Chord from Alaska stated that they reference the VR-DD guidance document to help guide our work, it has been very helpful! They have an MOU, but more detail is needed.
- Megan Burr from Washington says they address this in their [MOU with VR](#) as well as in their contracts with county providers.
- Darrell Spears Jr. from Connecticut has created presentation to communicate their expectations of provider agencies. This has been shared internally and externally to help people to understand the collaboration and braiding of funds. They broke down stakeholder services offered, eligibility, outline examples of how this may look, etc. There is a time commitment to formalizing the processes, but let's the groups know this can happen and services can be intertwined. They mitigate audit vulnerabilities by referring people between agencies as needed through formal documentation so the information sharing and relationships are clear.
- Joe Longcor from Michigan commented that their approach has not been as formal, but language is incorporated into policies about what is and what isn't CIE to avoid confusion about where services fall. Michigan does have language in it's [VR interagency agreement](#) that "...it is allowable to braid services..." which may be found on page 13 under the Comparable Benefits/Payor of Last Resort heading. Page 13 also has simple examples to underscore such braiding. This topic is echoed on Page 14 again under the Comparable Benefits/Payor of Last Resort Heading.

- Wesley Anderson from the SELN National Team posed several questions to consider, including:
 - How are you communicating what your system can do to your provider community?
 - How transparent is the audit process?
 - What do they know about the audit process now?
 - How can you not only mitigate audit concerns, but also mitigate fear?
- Stephanie Jones from Maryland asked how states are incorporating remote supports into service delivery and whether that option is called out explicitly in service descriptions.
 - Sandy Keyser from Missouri commented that they included some language in waiver definitions about supporting individuals remotely, such as a job coach or benefits planner using a virtual platform instead of being in person. Additional language clarifies that remote support is not just a phone call or a text. Virtual Delivery of Services is how defined on [pages 170 - 174\) of the Missouri Developmental Disabilities Waiver Program Manual](#).
 - Kristy Howe from Minnesota stated they have language that specifically speaks to using remote supports as well. Feel free to reach out to her if you'd like to learn more.
 - Darrell Spears Jr. from Connecticut mentioned they are just beginning to look into this, but don't have anything in operation yet.
 - Megan Burr from Washington shared that they allow remote services for individual employment. It isn't called it out; however, they require any remote supports to meet their billable activities requirements. It's a modality of service delivery. They do not allow this for community day service. Details are available in the [Washington Developmental Disabilities Teleservice policy](#).
 - Kristine Snyder from New York said they address Supported Employment services delivered remotely through an [Administrative Memorandum with details on pages 12-13](#).
 - Christine Gudgin from Georgia stated that they have added remote services to many of their waiver services including Supported Employment. The person must agree to their use in their individual service plan, remote service platforms must be HIPAA compliant and secure, and a minimum of two in person contacts a month are required.
 - Alix Dean from New Mexico shared that they allow the option to have remote-based personal supports for employment services. She recommends training the providers

extensively to make this a viable service delivery option. [This guide](#) can be used to implement technology that allows for remote employment support services and is a great resource for leveraging all kinds of technology on the HCBS waivers within DDSD's purview.

- Eric Williams from Virginia mentioned that they allow for "Telemedicine" (remote services) with Individual and Group SE, as well as Workplace Assistance.
- Gail Godwin from the SELN National Team commented that it is important to distinguish between remote or virtual service that are “indirect” service delivery or on behalf of a person versus directly working with the person delivering the service whether in person or virtually.

E-Learning Course

- Enrollment for the winter section ends February 6, 2026.
- The winter section ends February 13, 2026.
- The spring section begins on February 23, 2026.

Hub Huddles

- The January 23, 2026, Hub Huddle at 2:30 PM: Navigation Tips, How to Continue the Conversation from the MNM.

Upcoming Network Meetings

- February 18, 2026
- March 18, 2026
- April 15, 2026 - Spring Showcase

Materials

- [Slides](#)
- [Recording](#)